



# ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

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## STUDENT COUNSELLING & WELFARE COMMITTEE

### ANNUAL ACTIVITY REPORT

#### Academic Year 2024–2025

##### 1. Introduction

The Student Counselling & Welfare Committee of St. Ann's College for Women functions as an important student-support mechanism to promote the academic, emotional, personal, social and overall well-being of students. The Committee provides a supportive and confidential environment in which students can discuss academic difficulties, personal concerns, adjustment issues, interpersonal challenges and other matters affecting their educational experience.

During the academic year 2024–2025, the Committee undertook various counselling, awareness, mentoring, welfare and student-support initiatives in coordination with the IQAC, Heads of Departments, Mentor–Mentee System, Women Empowerment Cell, Grievance Redressal Cell, Anti-Ragging Committee and other student-support mechanisms.

##### 2. Objectives

The major objectives of the Committee were:

1. To provide guidance and counselling support to students facing academic, personal or emotional difficulties.
2. To facilitate students' adjustment to college life and promote a positive learning environment.
3. To identify students requiring additional support and provide appropriate guidance.
4. To promote mental well-being, self-confidence, resilience and positive relationships.
5. To assist students in addressing academic stress, examination-related concerns and career-related issues.
6. To create awareness regarding student welfare, safety, dignity, rights and responsibilities.
7. To provide appropriate referral and follow-up support wherever necessary.

8. To strengthen the Mentor–Mentee System as an accessible first-level student-support mechanism.
9. To promote an inclusive and supportive campus environment conducive to holistic development.
10. To maintain appropriate records of counselling and welfare activities while respecting student confidentiality and privacy.

### **3. Major Activities Undertaken During 2024–2025**

#### **A. Student Orientation and Induction Support**

The Committee supported student orientation and induction activities for newly admitted students. Students were introduced to the academic environment, student-support mechanisms, mentoring system, discipline, campus facilities and available welfare services.

**Outcome:**

Students were familiarised with the institutional support systems and encouraged to approach mentors and designated committees whenever assistance was required.

#### **B. Individual Counselling and Student Guidance**

Individual counselling and guidance were provided to students who approached the Committee or were referred through mentors and departments.

Areas of support included:

- Academic difficulties
- Examination-related stress
- Time management
- Personal concerns
- Adjustment to college life
- Interpersonal issues
- Motivation and self-confidence
- Attendance and academic participation
- Family-related concerns affecting studies
- Career and higher-education guidance

**Outcome:**

Students received timely guidance and were encouraged to adopt positive coping strategies and appropriate academic and personal practices.

**C. Mentor–Mentee Support**

The Committee worked in coordination with the **Mentor–Mentee System** to identify students requiring additional academic, personal or welfare support.

Mentors interacted with students periodically and brought significant concerns to the attention of the appropriate authorities or support mechanism.

**Outcome:**

The mentor–mentee system strengthened communication between students and faculty and facilitated early identification of student-support needs.

**D. Academic Stress and Examination Support**

Students were guided on managing academic pressure and examination-related stress.

Counselling focused on:

- Effective study planning
- Time management
- Preparation for internal and semester examinations
- Maintaining regular attendance
- Managing examination anxiety
- Developing positive study habits
- Balancing academic and co-curricular responsibilities

**Outcome:**

Students were encouraged to approach examinations with greater confidence and improved preparedness.

**E. Awareness on Mental Health and Emotional Well-being**

Awareness and guidance were provided to promote students' emotional well-being and encourage them to seek timely support whenever required.

Students were encouraged to:

- Maintain a healthy daily routine

- Communicate concerns with trusted persons
- Develop positive peer relationships
- Avoid unhealthy coping mechanisms
- Seek professional support whenever necessary
- Maintain a balanced approach towards academic and personal responsibilities

**Outcome:**

The initiative contributed to creating greater awareness about emotional well-being and the importance of seeking help when required.

### **F. Student Welfare and Support Services**

The Committee facilitated awareness among students regarding institutional welfare mechanisms and encouraged students to make use of available support services.

Students were guided regarding:

- Grievance Redressal mechanisms
- Anti-Ragging measures
- Women-related support mechanisms
- Scholarship and welfare schemes
- Mentor–Mentee support
- Career and placement guidance
- Health and safety support
- Academic assistance

**Outcome:**

Students became more aware of the various support systems available within the institution.

### **G. Career and Higher Education Guidance**

Students were encouraged to consider appropriate career pathways and higher-education opportunities according to their interests, abilities and academic performance.

Guidance included:

- Higher education opportunities

- Professional courses
- Skill development
- Competitive examinations
- Employment opportunities
- Career planning
- Placement preparedness

**Outcome:**

Students were encouraged to make informed decisions regarding higher education, employability and career development.

#### **H. Support for Students Facing Academic Difficulties**

Students showing academic difficulties were identified through interaction with mentors and faculty members. Appropriate guidance was provided to improve:

- Attendance
- Classroom participation
- Study habits
- Subject preparation
- Assignment completion
- Examination preparation

Where necessary, students were encouraged to seek additional academic assistance from concerned faculty members.

**Outcome:**

The intervention promoted early academic support and encouraged students to take responsibility for their academic progress.

#### **I. Promotion of a Safe and Inclusive Campus**

The Committee worked in coordination with other institutional committees to promote a **safe, respectful, inclusive and student-friendly campus environment**.

Students were sensitised regarding:

- Respectful behaviour

- Gender sensitivity
- Prevention of harassment
- Anti-ragging practices
- Responsible use of social media
- Maintaining discipline and dignity
- Respect for diversity and inclusion

**Outcome:**

The activities reinforced the institution's commitment to student safety, dignity, equality and holistic development.

#### **J. Referral and Follow-up Support**

Where a student's concern required specialized assistance beyond the scope of routine counselling, appropriate referral and follow-up were facilitated through the concerned institutional authority or professional support mechanism, wherever applicable.

Follow-up interactions were undertaken to monitor the student's progress and ensure continuity of support.

**Outcome:**

The referral and follow-up mechanism helped ensure that students received appropriate support according to the nature of their concerns.

#### **4. Coordination with Other Student-Support Mechanisms**

During the academic year, the Student Counselling & Welfare Committee coordinated with:

- IQAC
- Heads of Departments
- Mentor–Mentee System
- Grievance Redressal Cell
- Anti-Ragging Committee
- Internal Complaints Committee
- Women Empowerment Cell
- Equal Opportunity Cell / SC-ST / Minority Cell

- NSS
- NCC
- Training & Placement Cell
- Student Clubs and other institutional committees

Such coordination helped establish a **comprehensive student-support ecosystem** within the institution.

## 5. Major Outcomes

The activities of the Student Counselling & Welfare Committee during 2024–2025 resulted in the following:

1. Improved awareness among students regarding available counselling and welfare services.
2. Strengthened faculty–student communication through mentoring and counselling.
3. Timely identification and guidance of students facing academic and personal difficulties.
4. Increased awareness of mental and emotional well-being.
5. Support for students in managing academic and examination-related stress.
6. Improved awareness of grievance, safety and welfare mechanisms.
7. Encouragement towards responsible decision-making and positive behaviour.
8. Promotion of an inclusive, safe and supportive campus environment.
9. Strengthened coordination among various student-support committees.
10. Contribution towards the holistic development and well-being of students.

## 6. Conclusion

The Student Counselling & Welfare Committee actively contributed to creating a supportive and student-centered educational environment during the academic year 2024–2025. Through counselling, mentoring, welfare guidance, awareness initiatives and coordination with various institutional support mechanisms, the Committee endeavoured to address the diverse academic, personal and developmental needs of students.

The initiatives undertaken during the year strengthened the institution's commitment to student well-being, holistic development, inclusiveness, safety and academic success, in alignment with the quality enhancement objectives of the institution and the broader expectations of **NAAC**.

**Prepared by:**

**Student Counselling & Welfare Committee**

St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur

**Submitted to:**

**IQAC / Principal**

**Academic Year: 2024–2025**